Zenith Admin Guide

A quick-start manual for managing zenithccprep.org.

Start here: the rules that matter most

1. **The newsletter has no Publish button.** Tick **Published (visible on the site)** and click **Save issue**. That's the whole step. (Updates work the other way: a new update is published by default.)
2. **The Newsletter page leads with the highest issue number, not the newest save.** Give each issue a higher number than the last. An issue numbered lower than one already published goes to *Past issues*.
3. **Nothing goes on the Comets page without a signed release on file.** The Publish button stays greyed out until you record one. For anyone under 18, it must come from a parent or guardian.

> **Right now:** email notifications aren't switched on yet, so no form sends you an email. Check **Families, Contacts, Community, Partners, Nominations, and Feedback** in the admin yourself. Details are in section 9. *Delete this note once email is live.*

If it's in the sidebar, it's yours to manage. If it's words or layout on a page, send it to BOSS ME Technology at Zenith@bossmenow.com (section 12).

1. Logging in

1. Go to **https://zenithccprep.org/admin**
2. Enter the admin password.
3. You'll land on the **Dashboard**.

You'll stay logged in for about 7 days. Click **Sign out** in the bottom-left of the sidebar at any time to sign out.

> **If you forget the password:** email Zenith@bossmenow.com. It's stored in the hosting settings and can be reset there.

Please don't share the password. Keep it in a password manager.

2. The Dashboard

The Dashboard is your home screen. It shows:

- **Tile counters**: how many entries each section holds (Families, Community, Partners, Contacts, Newsletter Issues, Subscribers, Updates)
- **Most recent submissions**: the five newest entries across all the forms

Click any tile or any row to drill into the full list.

3. The admin sections

The sidebar has eleven sections.

Section	What it is
Dashboard	Counts and the five most recent submissions
Families	Parents and guardians who joined the interest list to enroll a student: parent name, email, phone, student name, current grade, expected entry grade, ZIP code, and how they heard about Zenith
Community	Supporters who signed up: neighbors, educators, allies. Shows their role(s), interests, and ZIP code
Partners	Organizations interested in partnering (sponsorships, internships, dual enrollment, and so on): the organization, contact person, and what they bring
Contacts	Messages sent through the "Contact us" form: name, email, subject, and message
Newsletter	The Comet Trail issues: create, edit, publish, and archive (see section 6)
Subscribers	People who signed up on the Newsletter page: an optional name and an email
Updates	The news posts that appear on the public **/updates** page (see section 5)
Nominations	Student and alumni nominations waiting for your review (see section 7)
Comets	Recognition profiles built from approved nominations (see section 7)
Feedback	Suggestions, corrections, and requested information that board members, faculty, and staff send from the sign-in page (see below)

Feedback from your team

The **Admin Sign In** page has a **Share feedback or suggest a change** button under the sign-in box. It's for board members, faculty, and staff to suggest a change, send information you've asked for (a bio or a quote, say), correct something on the site, or report a problem. They don't need to be signed in, and an email address is optional.

- Everything they send appears under **Feedback** in the sidebar, newest first, tagged with the topic and the sender's role.
- Click **Mark done** once you've handled an item. It moves to the **Done** tab, and **Reopen** brings it back. **Delete** removes it permanently.
- If the sender left an email, it shows as a link so you can reply. Many won't leave one.
- Because anyone who finds the sign-in page can use it, treat what's there as suggestions, not instructions. The form asks people not to include students' names or personal details.
- You'll only get a notification email for new feedback once email is switched on (section 9). Until then, check the **Feedback** page yourself.

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4. What you can do on each submissions page

On Families, Community, Partners, Contacts, and Subscribers you can:

- **Search**: type in the search box to filter the list
- **View detail**: every column is visible on the row
- **Export CSV**: click **Export CSV** in the top right. It downloads every entry in that section as a spreadsheet you can open in Excel or Google Sheets
- **Delete**: click the trash icon next to a row to remove it. Use sparingly; this is permanent

A note on privacy: the Families list contains children's names and grade levels, along with parents' contact details. Please don't share exports or screenshots outside the team, and delete downloaded files when you're done with them.

A note on spam: the Contacts list will occasionally collect unsolicited sales pitches (SEO services, marketing lists, and the like). They need no reply. Delete them.

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5. Creating Updates (news posts)

Updates are public announcements that appear at **zenithccprep.org/updates** and are linked from the site header and footer.

To create a new update

1. In the admin sidebar, click **Updates**
2. Click **New update** in the top right
3. Fill in:
    - **Title**: what readers see (for example, "We submitted our charter application")
    - **Slug**: the web address path (for example, `charter-submitted`; keep it short, no spaces). The site generates one from the title and you can edit it
    - **Body**: the post content. Plain text or basic Markdown (`**bold**`, `# Heading`). A blank line starts a new paragraph
    - **Publish date**: defaults to today
    - **Published**: **ticked by default**, so the post goes live as soon as you save. Untick it to save a draft
4. Click **Publish update**

The post is live at `zenithccprep.org/updates/your-slug`.

> **There is no scheduling.** A published post goes live the moment you save it. The publish date only sets the date shown on the post and the order posts appear in. Setting a future date does not hold it back.

To edit or hide an existing update

1. Go to **Updates** in the sidebar
2. Click **Edit** on the row you want to change
3. Make your changes (or untick **Published** to hide it)
4. Click **Save changes**

Adding pictures to a post

1. While writing or editing, click in the **Body** where you want the photo to appear
2. Click the **Add image** button (just above the Body box)
3. Choose a photo from your computer (JPG, PNG, WebP, or GIF, up to 10 MB)
4. It uploads and is inserted automatically as `![caption](link)`. Leave that text as-is; it becomes the picture on the published page
5. The text inside the square brackets (the file name by default) shows as a small caption under the photo. You can edit it to whatever caption you like
6. Click **Publish update** (or **Save changes**). The photo appears full-width on the live page

You can add several images to one post. Just repeat the steps for each.

Good update topics

- Charter application milestones
- Community engagement moments ("Visited Arizona Educational Foundation today")
- Board appointments or partnership announcements
- Calls to action ("Survey now available in Spanish. Please share!")
- Behind-the-scenes from school design work

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6. The Newsletter: "The Comet Trail"

The public **Newsletter** page (zenithccprep.org/newsletter) shows the latest published issue of The Comet Trail, with older issues in a **Past issues** archive below it. You write and edit issues entirely from the admin.

Three things to know first

1. **There is no separate Publish button.** Tick **Published (visible on the site)** and click **Save issue**. That is the whole step.
2. **Issues are drafts by default.** The Published box starts unticked. If you forget it, the issue saves as a draft and nobody sees it. (This is different from Updates, which are published by default.)
3. **The public page leads with the highest issue number, not the newest save.** If you save Issue 2 while a published Issue 5 already exists, Issue 2 goes to Past issues and Issue 5 stays on top. Give each new issue a higher number than the last.

Creating or editing an issue

1. In the admin sidebar, click **Newsletter**
2. Click **New issue** (or **Edit** next to an existing one)
3. Fill in the sections. Each one maps to a spot in the newsletter layout:
    - **Issue**: the issue number and a month label (for example, "September 2027")
    - **Top story**: lead photo, headline, a sentence or two, and an optional button
    - **From Dr. Samant**: a short, warm founder note
    - **Comet Spotlight**: a student or family photo, name, and a few sentences
    - **What's Happening**: up to three events with date, title, details, and link
    - **Inside the Classroom**: a short look at a project
    - **Big number**: one milestone, stated plainly (for example, "100%" and a sentence)

4. Any section you leave blank is simply hidden on the page, so you can't break the layout
5. To add a photo, click **Upload photo** in a section and choose an image from your computer
6. Tick **Published** if you want it live, then click **Save issue**

After you save

You return to the issue list with a message that tells you exactly what happened:

- **"Issue 03 is live."** It has the highest number, so it leads the public page. A **View on the site** button opens it.
- **"Issue 03 is published, but it is not the lead issue."** A higher-numbered issue exists, so this one appears under Past issues. The message names the higher issue. To make it the lead, edit it and give it a higher number.
- **"Issue 03 saved as a draft."** It's visible only in the admin. Click Edit, tick **Published**, and save again.

In the list, a green **Published** badge means an issue is on the site, and a grey **Draft** badge means it isn't. The issue currently leading the public page also carries a dark **Showing as latest** badge. Drafts always appear in this list, so if an issue isn't here at all, it was never saved.

If a save fails

While you write a new issue, the form backs up your work in your browser every couple of seconds. If a save fails, reopen **New issue** in the same browser and it offers to restore your text. Uploaded photos aren't part of the backup, so re-add them.

Subscribers, and emailing the newsletter

People who enter their email on the Newsletter page are saved under **Subscribers** in the admin sidebar (search, export CSV, delete, same as the other lists). The same person signing up twice never creates a duplicate.

The website publishes the newsletter on the site and collects subscriber emails. It does **not** email the newsletter itself. To send an issue by email:

1. Click **Subscribers**, then **Export CSV**
2. Import the list into your email tool (Mailchimp, Constant Contact, and so on)
3. Send from there, and link readers to zenithccprep.org/newsletter

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7. Comets: nominations and the recognition page

The **Comets** page (zenithccprep.org/alumni) recognizes students and graduates. It has two sections: **Comets in Motion** (current students reaching milestones such as dual enrollment or industry certifications) and **Comets Who've Landed** (graduates). Until the first class graduates in 2031, the second section shows a "coming soon" note.

Anyone can nominate a student or graduate at **zenithccprep.org/alumni/nominate**: students, staff, families, and community members. **Nothing is published automatically.** Every nomination comes to you first.

Step 1: Review nominations

1. Click **Nominations** in the sidebar. New ones appear under **Pending**
2. Read the story, the relationship of the person nominating, and any contact details. The nominator's email is for follow-up only and is never published
3. Choose:
    - **Approve**: creates an *unpublished draft profile* and shows you a link to finish it under Comets
    - **Reject**: asks for a short reason. The reason stays internal and is never shown publicly

Step 2: Finish the profile

1. Click **Comets** in the sidebar. Approved nominations appear there as drafts
2. Click **Edit** and complete the profile:
    - **Photo**, **headline** (the short line on the card), and **full story**
    - **Field tags** (for example, Healthcare, Skilled Trades), which power the "Browse by field" filter on the public page
    - **Certifications**, **grade or graduation year**, and the **milestone type**
    - **Section**: In Motion (currently enrolled) or Landed (graduated)
3. **Consent comes before publishing.** Tick **"A signed release is on file for this person"** and fill in **who signed, and when**. For anyone under 18, this must be a **parent or guardian**, not the student's own consent
4. Click **Save profile**

Step 3: Publish

Back on the Comets list, click **Publish**. **The Publish button stays greyed out until a signed release is on file.** The site itself also refuses to publish without one, so this isn't just a button. If you later untick the release, the profile comes down immediately.

To take a profile off the public page at any time, click **Unpublish**.

Mentors

Ticking **Available as a mentor** on a profile adds a "Connect with" button to that person's card. Messages sent through it are emailed to the school, never to the person directly, and the person's own contact details are never shown.

> **Mentor messages need email set up** (see section 9). Until then, leave this unticked: a message sent through the button would be lost.

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8. The public site

These are the parts of zenithccprep.org that visitors see. Page wording, photos, and layout are maintained by BOSS ME Technology in the website's code. To change any of them, send the requested changes to Zenith@bossmenow.com.

- **Home**: opening date (Fall 2027, founding 9th grade class), what makes Zenith different, core values, community, partners
- **Our Story**: mission, vision, why now, community engagement, and the welcome video
- **School Model**: academics, the AP-first pathway, advisory, the Elevate block, career pathways, financial literacy
- **Our Board**: founder bio and board members with expandable bios
- **FAQ**: answers to the questions families ask most often
- **Get Involved**: audience cards (Families, Community, Partners), the survey, and the sign-up forms
- **Updates**: the posts you create (section 5)
- **Newsletter**: the latest Comet Trail issue and archive (section 6). It shows a "coming soon" page with a signup box until the first issue is published
- **Comets**: the recognition page and nomination form (section 7)
- **Contact**: reaches the Contacts list in the admin

Two features appear across the site: an **"Opening Fall 2027"** band under the header on every page except the homepage (which carries the same message in its main banner), and a floating **Join the Interest List** button that appears as visitors scroll. Visitors can dismiss the button for the rest of their visit.

The community survey lives at **zenithccprep.org/get-involved#survey** and is powered by Google Forms (English and Spanish). Responses go to Google, not the admin panel: view them in the response spreadsheet in Google Drive. To change the questions, edit the Google Form directly. Changes appear on the site immediately, with no redeploy.

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9. Email notifications

When someone submits a form, the site is designed to send two emails: a **confirmation to the person who submitted** and a **notification to the Zenith team inbox**. Submissions are always saved and appear in the admin whether or not email is working.

> **Current status: email is not yet switched on.** Setting it up needs a few DNS records added to the domain (managed in Squarespace). Until that's done:
>
> - No notification emails reach the team. Check **Families, Contacts, Community, Partners, Nominations, and Feedback** in the admin regularly, and more often during recruitment pushes.
> - People who submit a form still see a thank-you message but don't receive a confirmation email.
> - Mentor "Connect with" messages are lost (see section 7).
>
> *Delete this box once email is live.*

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10. Common tasks at a glance

I want to…	Where to go
See how many families have signed up	Dashboard (or click **Families**)
Email everyone who joined the interest list	**Families** → Export CSV → mail merge from the spreadsheet
Post an announcement	**Updates** → New update → **Publish update**
Put a newsletter issue on the site	**Newsletter** → New issue → tick **Published** → **Save issue**
See which issue is leading the public page	**Newsletter** list: the row marked **Showing as latest**
Download newsletter subscribers	**Subscribers** → Export CSV
Review a Comet nomination	**Nominations** → Approve or Reject
See what the team has suggested	**Feedback** → New tab → **Mark done** when handled
Put a Comet profile on the public page	**Comets** → Edit → tick the signed release → Save profile → **Publish**
View survey responses	Google Drive → your Zenith form response sheet
Reply to a contact message	**Contacts** → copy their email → reply from your own inbox
Add a photo to an Updates post	**Updates** → New or Edit → **Add image**
Change page wording, a photo, or the layout	Email Zenith@bossmenow.com

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11. Quick troubleshooting

"Application error" on /admin The database may be temporarily unreachable. Wait a minute and reload. If it persists, email Zenith@bossmenow.com.

Login keeps failing

- Check Caps Lock
- Make sure the password matches exactly (no leading or trailing space)
- If you copied it from a message, retype it manually

I saved a newsletter issue but it isn't at the top of the Newsletter page Look at the issue list. If it says **Draft**, edit it and tick **Published**. If it says **Published** but another issue is marked **Showing as latest**, that other issue has a higher number. Edit yours and give it a higher number than that one.

A newsletter issue seems saved but I can't find it Drafts and published issues both appear in the Newsletter list. If it isn't there, the save didn't go through. Reopen **New issue** in the same browser and restore your backed-up draft.

An update I published isn't showing on /updates

- Confirm **Published** is ticked
- Hard-refresh the public page (Cmd+Shift+R on a Mac, Ctrl+Shift+R on Windows)

The Publish button on a Comet profile is greyed out A signed release isn't on file. Click **Edit**, tick **"A signed release is on file"**, add who signed and when, and save. Publish then becomes available.

At an event, a family sees "submitted this form several times recently" The forms limit how often a single internet connection can submit, to block spam. The interest list allows 100 per hour per connection, Community allows 20, and Contact and Partner allow 10. The interest list is set high on purpose so a busy tabling event doesn't turn families away, so you're unlikely to see this there. If someone does, switch them to phone data or wait a few minutes.

A form says thank you but I never got an email Check the admin list. The submission is saved even when email isn't (see section 9).

CSV export downloads an empty file That section genuinely has no submissions yet. It isn't an error.

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12. What you can do yourself, and what to send to BOSS ME Technology

Yours to do, with no developer needed: everything in the sidebar: Updates, the Newsletter, reviewing and exporting submissions, and the Comets queue.

Send to BOSS ME Technology (Zenith@bossmenow.com): page wording, photos and layout, new pages, navigation, the enrollment and lottery page, board bios, domain and DNS changes, hosting, email setup, and admin password resets.

Rule of thumb: if it's in the sidebar, it's yours. If it's words or layout on a page, send it over.

Appendix: suggested first walkthrough (30 minutes)

Time	Topic
0–5 min	Log in, tour the sidebar, the Dashboard
5–15 min	Newsletter: create a practice issue as a draft, publish it, then change its number and watch it move between the lead spot and Past issues. Delete it afterward.
15–20 min	Updates: write one and add a photo
20–25 min	Submissions: search, then export a CSV
25–30 min	The Comets queue, and questions

Delete this appendix once the walkthrough is done.

Last updated: October 2026